

they could not afford to build new ones. Construction resumed in the mid-1940s and carried right up to the late 1960s, when the inflation-adjusted Dow signaled the end of the Supercycle degree bull market, as depicted in Chapter 3. The average age of buildings has been rising ever since, reflecting the underlying bear market in force at larger degree. Figure 13-2 depicts the purchasing power of the average wage, which has acted similarly. It climbed steadily for decades until 1972-1973, peaking with a normal lag time following the orthodox top of the inflation-adjusted bull market (on a test of the high in January 1973). Despite rebounding slightly at each peak rate of change in the business cycle since then, average wages have declined steadily ever since, reflecting the larger corrective forces.

The Increasing Dominance of Negative Forces Since 1987

The underlying bear market trend since 1966 has subtly influenced the breadth and sociology of Cycle wave V throughout its progress. This has been particularly true since 1987 despite the continuation of the bull market in stocks because subwave ④ was a corrective force and subwave ⑤, which began in 1987, has been the weakest advance among the three Primary degree impulse waves. As such, it has barely been able to maintain dominance over the forces of the larger bear market.

For this reason, social psychology has deteriorated substantially since late 1987. Reflecting upon one aspect of that change, an article in *The Denver Post* on February 27, 1994 investigated numerous measures of social well-being and concluded that after years of flat statistics, "1987 was the year that things started to go wrong, the year the United States social misery indexes began exploding." Those measures include the numbers of juvenile arrests, children in foster care, hospital cocaine episodes, out of wedlock births among black Americans, addicted mothers, and the teen birth rate. Government regulation, as measured by the number of federal employees and the number of pages of regulation, also began soaring again in 1987. In sum, while the Cycle degree bull market in mood did resume after the 1987 crash, it has been increasingly bedeviled by waxing social chaos, as recorded in Figures 13-3a through 13-3f. These statistics are of particular interest given the Fibonacci time counts published in *Elliott Wave Principle* and *The Elliott Wave Theorist* that pointed years in advance to 1987 as the probable peak of the Supercycle, as detailed in Chapter 4. Though the article cited above states that "no social expert claims to understand" why the change